

Session Note - March 5, 2026

Patient: Sarah Chen

Therapist: Dr. Rebecca Torres, PsyD

Presenting Concerns:

Patient reports ongoing generalized anxiety with persistent worry about job performance and family responsibilities. Anxiety severity is moderate, with symptoms present for approximately six months. Reports difficulty concentrating at work as a secondary concern. Identified work deadlines and family conflict as primary triggers.

Session Summary:

Focused on cognitive behavioral therapy techniques to address catastrophic thinking about work performance. Patient identified three automatic negative thoughts and practiced cognitive restructuring with therapist guidance. Completed a brief relaxation training exercise. Patient demonstrated improved ability to challenge distorted thinking compared to previous sessions.

Mood Assessment:

Current mood: 6/10 (worried but managing)

Mood stability: Stable compared to last session

Energy level: Normal

Emotional themes include worry and determination.

Affect observed: Anxious

Affect congruence: Congruent with reported mood

Mental Status Examination:

Appearance: Well-groomed and appropriately dressed

Behavior: Cooperative and engaged throughout session

Speech: Normal rate, rhythm, and volume

Thought process: Linear and goal-directed

Thought content: Preoccupied with work performance concerns

Perception: No abnormalities noted

Cognition: Intact, alert and oriented

Insight: Good - able to recognize connection between thoughts and anxiety

Judgment: Good

Risk Assessment:

Suicidal ideation: None. Self-harm: None. Homicidal ideation: None. Risk level: Low. Safety plan: Not needed.

Interventions Used:

- Cognitive restructuring
- Relaxation training
- Psychoeducation about anxiety cycle

Techniques were effective - patient reported decreased anxiety by end of session.

Skills taught: Thought challenging worksheet, diaphragmatic breathing

Homework assigned: Complete thought diary entries daily and practice breathing exercises twice per day

Previous homework: Partially completed - did breathing exercises but missed some diary entries

Medications: Not applicable, not on psychotropic medications

Diagnoses:

Primary diagnosis: Generalized Anxiety Disorder

Primary diagnosis code: F41.1

Diagnosis status: No change from previous session

Treatment Progress:

Overall progress: Some improvement in anxiety management skills

Treatment phase: Middle

Barriers: Difficulty maintaining consistent practice between sessions

Strengths: Strong motivation and good therapeutic alliance

Treatment goals: Reduce anxiety to manageable levels, develop reliable coping toolkit

Goals addressed this session: Cognitive restructuring skill development

Plan:

- Continue weekly sessions
- Next session: March 12, 2026
- Focus next session on exposure hierarchy development
- No referrals needed
- Level of care: Outpatient
- Discharge planning: Not planned